CURRENT TOURS

AKTION / INSTALLATION / HÖRSTÜCK, HANNOVER, 2021



Current Tours (2021) Hannover

In May 2021, YRD.Works presented the participatory work Current Tours as part of the Herrenhausen Art Festival (KunstFestSpiele) in Hanover. With the project, the collective took up an aristocratic tradition cultivated in the Herrenhausen Gardens as early as the early 18th century. Back then, gondola rides were offered as a courtly amusement on the Graft, a canal around two kilometres long that encloses the gardens.

With Current Tours, YRD.Works revived this tradition: they built a 12 x 4 metre raft powered by an almost silent electric motor. Up to twelve people at a time could enjoy a roughly 40-minute trip along the canal. During the trip, passengers sat in small cabins that were open on two sides towards the banks. The trips took place several times a day during the festival and were accompanied by the artists, who steered the raft themselves. In addition to the regular trips, there were special tours at night and at dawn.

The slow raft rides opened up new perspectives on the Herrenhausen Gardens, as the constantly and almost imperceptibly shifting sightlines allowed new views of the strict geometry of the baroque garden landscape.

Borrowing from the audio guides of sightseeing tours, headphones on board allowed the audience to listen to an experimental sound collage during the trip. The generative audio piece was produced by YRD.Works in collaboration with the composer and radio play author Oliver Augst. The collage, consisting of fragmented musical contributions by Charlotte Simon and Elias Gottstein and a multitude of original sound recordings collected on the internet, rearranged itself on every trip through an algorithm developed by Augst. In terms of content, the piece addressed the growing complexity of global financial systems — a subject that even experts no longer fully understand. The constant recombination of sound fragments created multi-layered references that offered ironic commentary on the fragmented perception of modern financial systems while reflecting their contradictions and dynamics.

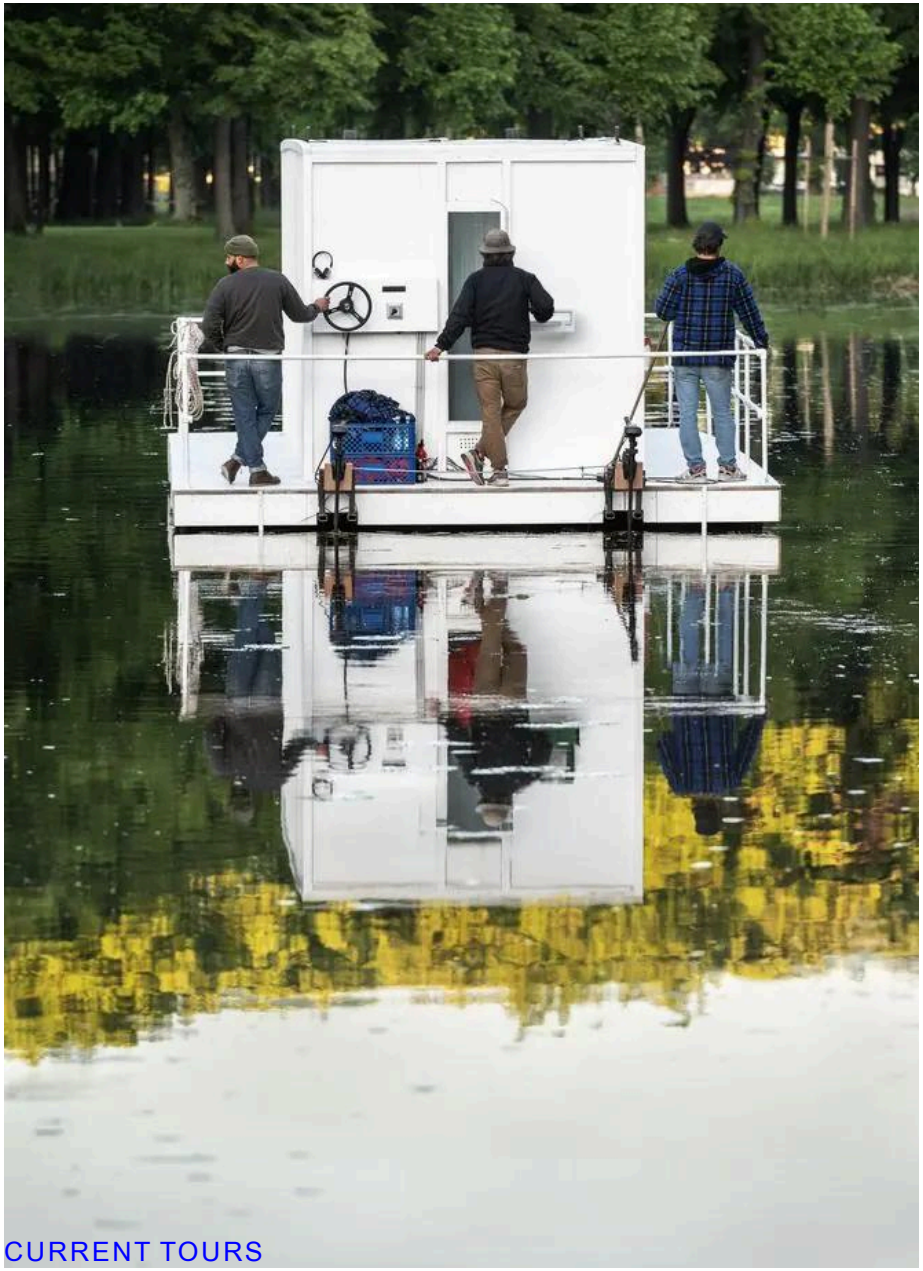


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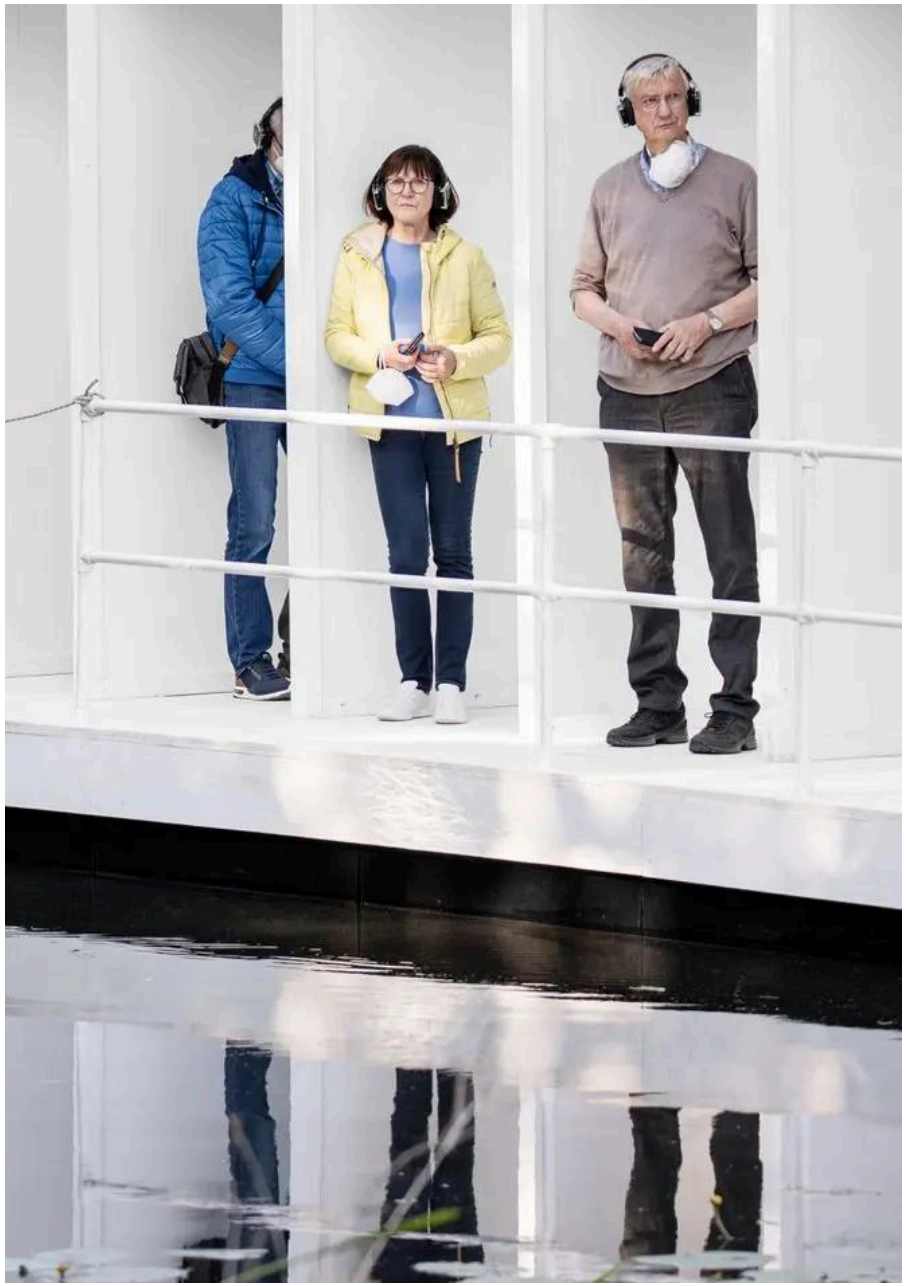
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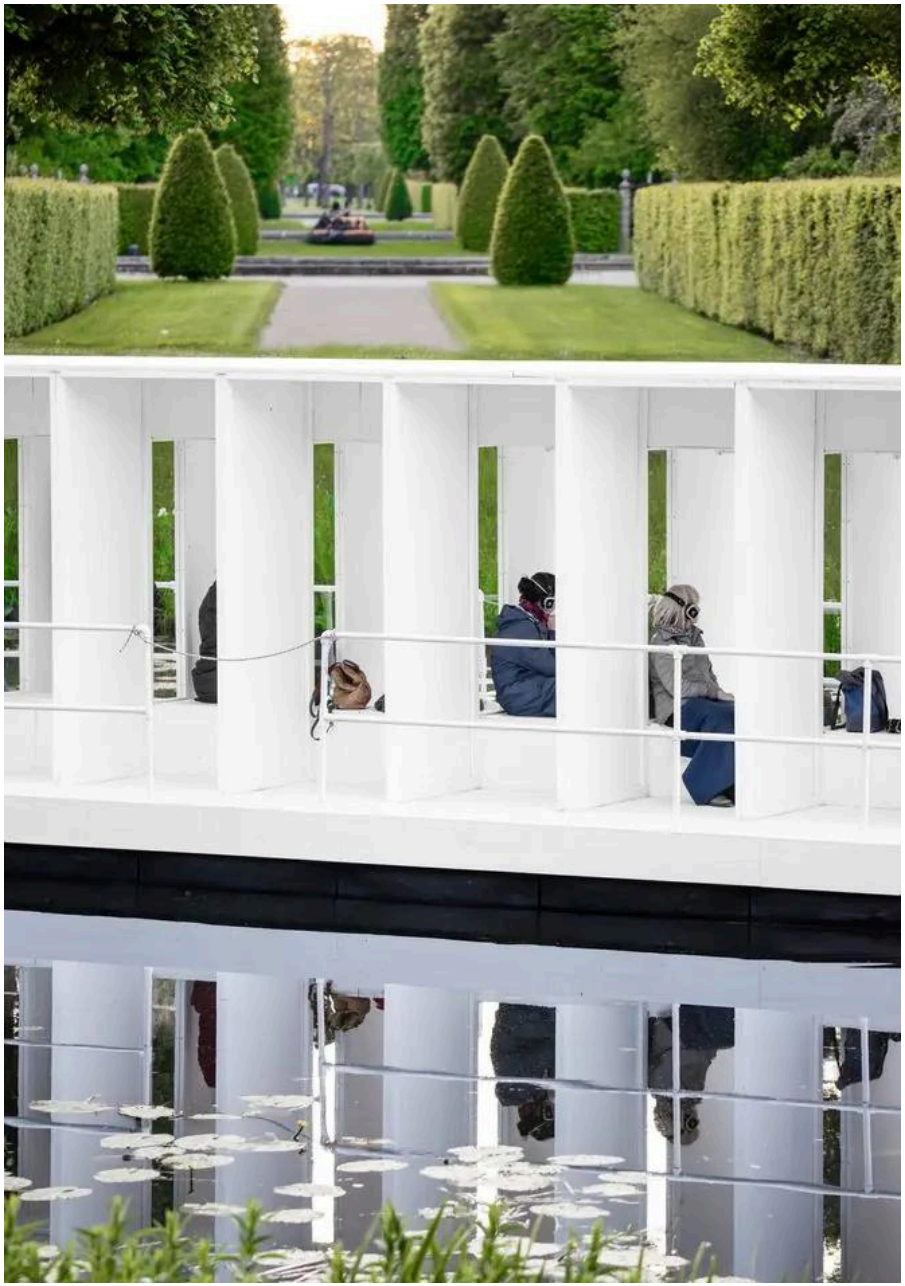
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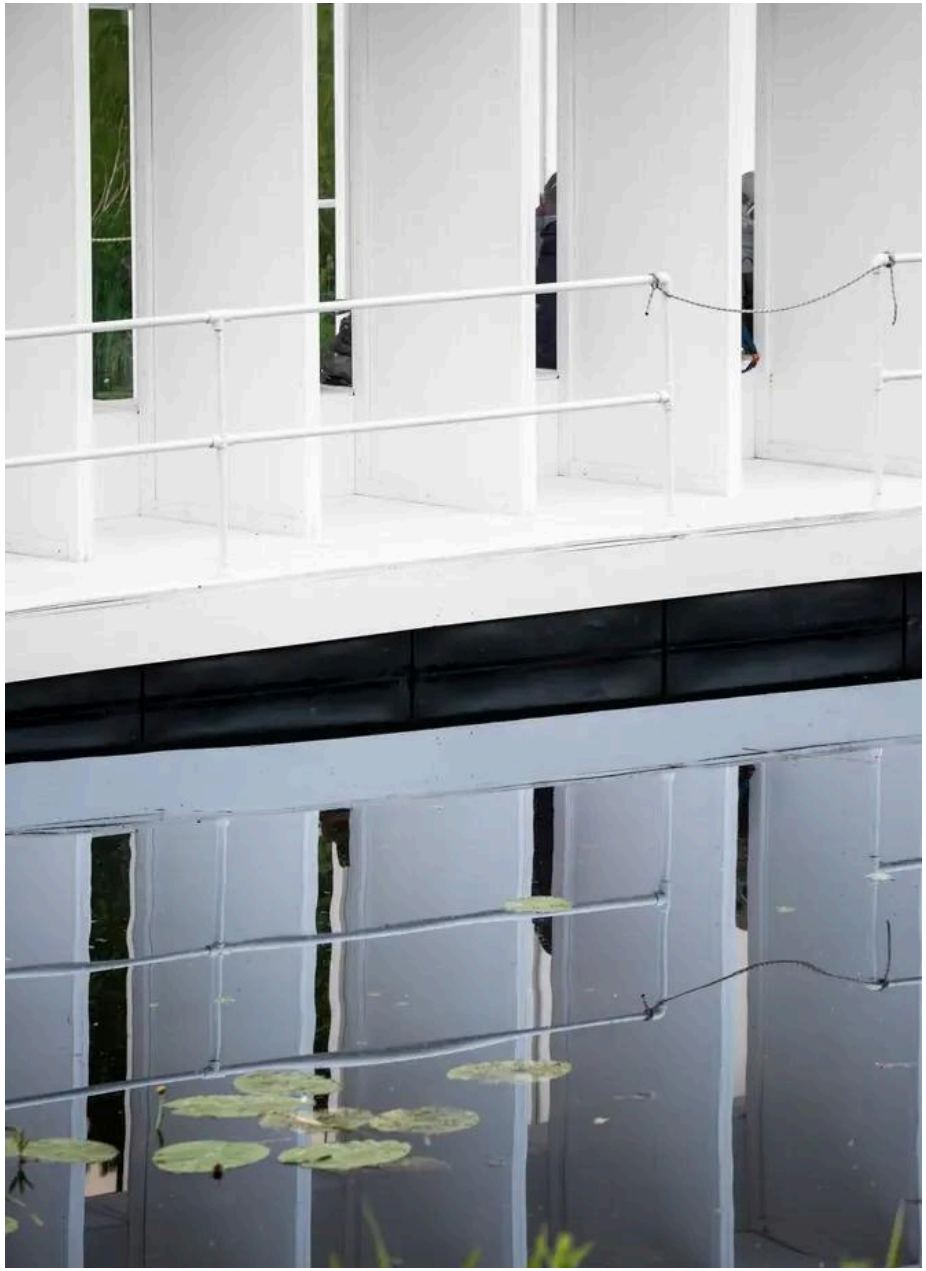


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